IB DIGITAL SOCIETY · ECONOMIC CONTEXT

When a business grows, who gains?

From a single click to the systems, workers and rules behind business growth.

SEE IT → TEST IT → JUDGE IT



Operation 7 · Lesson + Northstar decision lab

Economics asks how digital systems move value—and power.

GOODS / SERVICE

What reaches the user?

MONEY

Who pays whom?

DATA

What coordinates the decision?

CONTROL

Who can change the rule?

The same system can create convenience for one stakeholder and a new dependency for another.

Ask throughout: useful to whom, costly to whom, and under what conditions?

A sale becomes data—and then a decision.

1	SCAN	item + quantity
2	RECORD	sale + payment
3	CHECK	stock rule
4	ACT	reorder / deliver



Purpose is not proof of impact.

Conceptual illustration · trace input → processing → output → purpose

FRAMEWORK · FOUR DIRECTIONS

Growth changes the offer, chain, audience or industry.

OFFER

Horizontal

add pens

CHAIN

Vertical

own delivery

AUDIENCE

Concentric

school kits

INDUSTRY

Conglomerate

bike repair

Classify the specified move—not the whole company.

Northstar is fictional · the framework is chapter-aligned



What changed—and what new responsibility appeared?

A bakery buys its flour supplier.

Your classification

_____

New responsibility

A bakery opens a phone-repair shop.

Your classification

_____

New responsibility

If two answers differ, identify the scenario detail that would settle the boundary.

Every growth move creates a package of trade-offs.

BENEFIT

What improves?

reach · speed · control · revenue

COST

What must be paid?

setup · labour · systems · coordination

DEPENDENCY

What could constrain it?

capacity · suppliers · rules · demand

Then ask: which stakeholder receives each benefit, cost or risk?

Make one decision. Change one variable. Explain one result.

ROUND 1	Change the growth decision
ROUND 2	Keep strategy; change staff policy
ROUND 3	Keep both; introduce disruption



RECORD

prediction → result →
bottleneck → limitation

Model results are not real-world facts.

Use the interactive lab on the published lesson page

More demand is not the same as more output—or more cash.

100

orders completed

$180

operating surplus

–$1,020

first-round cash

Vertical trial · synthetic comparison

The model calculates costs and capacity.

It does not calculate well-being, fairness, injury, loyalty or long-term productivity.

Faster processing and worker experience are separate questions.

COMPANY ACCOUNT

What performance does Amazon claim?

REGULATORY RECORD

What safety measures does the settlement require?



Neither source alone proves every worker's experience.

Compare date · country · workforce · measure

Use the 3Cs to turn vocabulary into an argument.

CONTENT

tracking · algorithms · networks

CONCEPT

power · systems · change

CONTEXT

economic

MECHANISM → STAKEHOLDER → IMMEDIATE IMPACT → IMPLICATION

Label each arrow with why the relationship exists. Attach a source—or label it as a hypothesis.

ASSIGNMENT LAUNCH · SUPPLY CHAIN DETECTIVE

Follow one order beyond the screen.

1	**BOUND**	one product or digital title
2	**TRACE**	goods/service · money · data · control
3	**EXPLAIN**	one consequential digital decision
4	**JUDGE**	cost + benefit + stakeholder implication

Do not invent hidden infrastructure.

Assignment handout provides the planning frame and evidence checklist



Can you explain a new case without the model?

An unfamiliar music service buys a ticket-delivery business.

1. Classify the growth move.
2. Name one new dependency.
3. Explain one stakeholder trade-off.
4. Identify one fact needed before judging.

Tomorrow's work: build a bounded route, explain the mechanism, and defend a conditional judgment.

ctwadden.github.io/digital-society-sl/lessons/economics-business-growth/